



# Amending a Job That's Already with Us

When a change needs a fresh certificate, and what to send.

Designs move on. Tell us before the change is built — a certificate covers the plans it was issued against and nothing else, and work on site that doesn't match its approval is the hardest problem to fix later.

## TELL US IF ANY OF THIS CHANGES

- ✓ Size — length, width, height, or span
- ✓ Position on the lot, or setback to any boundary
- ✓ Roof pitch, roof sheet, or the framing material
- ✓ Post or column spacing
- ✓ Footing size, depth or type
- ✓ How the structure attaches to the dwelling
- ✓ The engineering, or the engineer

## YOU USUALLY DON'T NEED US FOR

- ✗ Colour changes, where nothing structural moves
- ✗ Gutter or downpipe profile, provided discharge is unchanged
- ✗ A different supplier for the same certified product

## HOW AN AMENDMENT WORKS

### 1 You Send Us the Change

Use *Amend a job* in the portal, or email the office: the job number, what's different, revised drawings, and updated engineering if the structure has changed.

### 2 We Open It as a New Job

Its own reference and its own assessment, linked back to the original. It is not an edit to the certificate you already hold.

### 3 We Assess the Change

Against the same standards as any other job. If it affects setbacks, bushfire, retained height or fire separation, expect the same questions as first time.

### 4 A New Certificate Is Issued

Covering the amended design. The original is unchanged and stays valid for the work it described.

### 5 You Lodge It with the Permit Authority

A new certificate generally means an amended building permit application to the local government. That's their timeframe, not ours — allow for it.



## WHAT TO SEND

- ✓ The original job number
- ✓ A plain description of what's changed
- ✓ Revised drawings — site plan and elevations, both showing the change
- ✓ Updated engineering where anything structural has moved
- ✓ A revised BAL assessment if the footprint has moved in a bushfire prone area
- ✓ Whether any of the work has already been built
- ✓ Whether a building permit has already been issued

**If you're unsure, ask before you build.** A two-minute phone call costs nothing. Rectifying built work that doesn't match its approval can cost a great deal.

## TIMING — WHERE A JOB IS WHEN IT CHANGES

| WHEN THE CHANGE COMES UP                                  | WHAT HAPPENS                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Before we've certified it</b>                          | Easiest case. Send the revised drawings and we'll assess the current design — no amendment needed, though it may reset where the job sits in the queue.                                    |
| <b>After we've certified, before the permit is issued</b> | We issue an amended certificate. Get it to the permit authority before they determine the application, or you may end up amending the permit as well.                                      |
| <b>After the permit is issued</b>                         | Amended certificate from us, then an amended permit application to the local government. Don't build the change until that's done.                                                         |
| <b>After the work is built</b>                            | Tell us straight away and say so plainly. Built work that departs from an approval is a different and more difficult problem, and it is far better raised by you than found at inspection. |

## WHY AN AMENDMENT OPENS A NEW JOB RATHER THAN EDITING THE OLD ONE

A certificate of design compliance is a statutory document. It records that a registered building surveyor assessed a specific set of plans on a specific date and formed the view they complied. That record can't be rewritten after the fact — so an amendment is assessed and certified in its own right, and both certificates remain on file. If anyone later asks what was approved and when, the answer is complete.

**Don't build to a change until the amendment is certified.** It's the one thing that turns a straightforward amendment into a serious problem. If the work is already underway, stop that element and talk to us first.